

do several organizations offer Linux compatible software, the open source community has also done enough to keep you and your copy of Linux relevant. Photoshop can be replaced by Gimp, Corel Draw by Inkscape, MS Office by Open Office and Libre Office. The list is seemingly endless and can be found at osalt.com and opensourcealternative.org. When you factor in the “cloud”, software seems less and less relevant.

2. The alternatives are not as good as the original

While some amount of validity can be seen in the above argument, the counter argument is Wine. Wine is a compatibility layer that easily allows users to run Windows compatible programs on Linux based OSes. Wine stands for Wine Is Not an Emulator and works by translating the commands on the fly instead of simulating Windows logic. Wine is used not only on computers but also even in synthesisers.

3. Windows is more widely available

Microsoft largely ensures that computer manufacturers distribute copies of Windows with their machines. Some sources say that Microsoft sells copies to manufacturers at almost a tenth of the price it charges customers. Microsoft and Apple also aggressively meet offices and educational institutions and get them to use their products. But the fact that Linux is clearly the more cost effective option can be seen very clearly in developing nations in Africa and Asia where it is slowly but surely gaining traction.

4. Confused by choice

Simply put, there are too many iterations of freely distributable Linux. While each one has its own purpose and use, the annoying part is that they're not all compatible with each other. Even though they're all Linux, a program meant for Red Hat won't work on Debian and vice versa.



Powering devices soon

5. Gaming

While gaming isn't the biggest reason people use computers, whether or not it runs games is a deciding factor when say, a family buys a computer. The fact that many titles weren't made for Linux was a big reason why the number of people who grew up with Linux are few and far between. Fortunately game developer Valve is trying to fix that through